iron can be given. Consumption of liver once or twice a week is effective in combating such a tendency. Particular emphasis may be placed upon the inclusion of those green leafy vegetables which are good source of iron like cauliflower, greens and agathi and whole grain or enriched breads and to certain iron-rich dry fruits, and use of iron fortified salt.

Some features of old age such as delayed wound healing, decreased taste sensitivity and anorexia are also findings associated with zinc deficiency. However, healthy elderly subjects have been shown to be in zinc balance despite an apparent low dietary intake. Older people who avoid flash foods maybe at increased risk of poor zinc status.

f) Vitamins

Elderly people are at risk for vitamin D deficiency due to decreased exposure to sunlight or decrease in renal mass. Prudent dietary supplementation with calcium and Vitamin D improves bone density prevent fractures.. Recent studies have indicated that people with parkinson's disease are likely to have low Vitamin D levels.

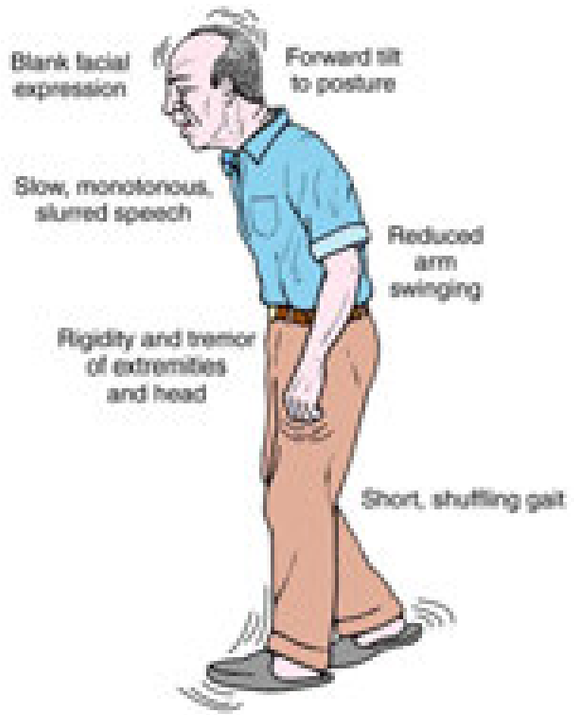


Fig 4.2 Parkinson's disease Symptoms

The antioxidant vitamins, such as vitamin E, carotenoids and vitamin C have been promoted as agents that enhance the health of the elderly.

Vitamin C may be protective against cataract at an intake level of between 150 and 250 mg per day.which is possible to achieve from dietary sources alone.

Vitamin E has also been found to be a potent nutrient for reducing the decline in cellular immunity that occur in the elderly. Changes in immune system can be overcome by taking 200 mg of vitamin E. Protection from DNA damage enhances the body's self defence mechanisms.

Requirements for the vitamin B6 are increased in many elderly persons owing to atrophic gastritis which interferes with absorption. Decrease absorption can lead to pernicious anemia. So consumption of folate rich foods should be encouraged.

Consumption of green leafy vegetables may supply enough vitamin K during old age.

All vitamin requirements remain the same as the adult requirement.

g) Water

It is essential for the older person as it is for the younger individual. The kidney can function more adequately when there is sufficient fluid (1.5 litres) to eliminate the solid waste. Water stimulates peristalsis and thus aids in combating constipation. Water can be consumed such or in the form of buttermilk, fruit juices porridge and soups.

h) Fibre.

Fibre stimulates peristalsis. There is great enthusiasm to encourage the consumption of fibre containing food but any increase should be gradual otherwise bowel discomfort, distension and flatulence will result. While rough fibre, bran and mature vegetables are

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